

Plutarch





About the Course

Plutarch's Lives is a collection of biographies written 2,000 years ago, which has influenced prominent thinkers from Montaigne to Bacon to Shakespeare. Plutarch's stories are often difficult to read (and are therefore often dropped by teachers), but their value to help students evaluate the characteristics that define a good citizen cannot be overstated. The lesson plans will contain additional support to what is already included in the Anne White guides.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 6, Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada), Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

Students in 5th grade or new to Plutarch may want to take the Beginner's Track, which covers the life of Publicola over two terms. It is advisable to have students read Beesly's Stories from the History of Rome and complete one year of Shakespeare before beginning Plutarch.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
6-8+	Plutarch: Grades 6-8 1 time/week 30 min	Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed. The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 6				
	Plutarch: Grades 6-8	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8
Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 6

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

☐ Watch the video in Quick Links about teaching Plutarch.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Plutarch: Grades 6-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace* book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1		
WEEK 1	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 1	
WEEK 2	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 2	
WEEK 3	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 3	
WEEK 4	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 4	
WEEK 5	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 5	
WEEK 6	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 6	
WEEK 7	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 7	
WEEK 8	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 8	
WEEK 9	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 9	
WEEK 10	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 10	
WEEK 11	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 11	
WEEK 12	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 12	

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

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Term 2		
WEEK 1	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 13	
WEEK 2	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 14	
WEEK 3	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 15	
WEEK 4	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 16	
WEEK 5	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 17	
WEEK 6	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 18	
WEEK 7	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 19	
WEEK 8	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 20	
WEEK 9	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 21	
WEEK 10	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 22	
WEEK 11	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 24	

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3		
WEEK 1	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 3	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 36	